

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

5th September, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

36th WEEK



NORTH KOREA & USA

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



Learning Space

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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

5th SEPTEMBER, 2017

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Sabre-rattling

Direct talks are the only way out to de-escalate the crisis in the Korean peninsula

North Korea's adventurism continues unabated. On Sunday, it tested what it claims was a "hydrogen bomb", its sixth nuclear weapons test, cocking a snook at non-proliferation and international test ban laws, as well as at U.S. President Donald Trump. Even as the tests drew global condemnation, this was clearly a response to Mr. Trump's sabre-rattling rhetoric claiming that the U.S. would rain "fire and fury" over the country and implying that its nuclear weapons were "locked and loaded" to respond to any threat from North Korea. Mr. Trump's response to Sunday's development was to ratchet up threats, besides calling out U.S. ally South Korea for "appeasement" and threatening to cut trade ties with countries that conduct any form of business with the North Koreans. Clearly the tough talk is not working – it is only pushing North Korea's totalitarian regime to take even more provocative steps in a quest to attain the status of a *de facto* nuclear power. In response to the exacerbated tensions in the region, South Korea and Japan have significantly enhanced their defence capabilities, including spending on missile defence. South Korea's new President Moon Jae-in, who is in favour of talks, has now accepted the U.S.'s missile defence system, THAAD, which is opposed locally by many South Koreans.

North Korea relies on increasing militarisation and show of missile and nuclear prowess for various reasons. Part of its ploy is to convince its impoverished and isolated citizenry of the need for the country to attain military parity in light of the presence of the U.S. military shield in South Korea and Japan. Another part of it is to justify the years of the Kim family rule, as these tests add to the myth of strong leadership by its 33-year-old,

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Testing the world: Why N Korea's 'hydrogen bomb' may portend a danger like no other

SUSHANT SINGH puts Pyongyang's test in perspective, answers key questions on what may lie ahead

North Korea keeps testing nuclear bombs and missiles; what has it tested now?

On Sunday, North Korea claimed that it had tested a hydrogen nuclear bomb. The underground blast was very powerful — international news organisations said experts had estimated the explosion was at least four, and up to 16 times stronger than any that Pyongyang had set off earlier. Experts also said, however, that it was possible what was tested was actually a "boosted" atomic bomb that uses tritium, a common enhancement technique for a higher explosive yield. Sunday's nuclear test was North Korea's sixth overall and fourth under President Kim Jong-un — the first this year after two last year and one in 2013. Kim's father, Kim Jong-il, first tested in 2006, and again in 2009. North Korea has also launched as many as 14 missiles between February 11 and August 29 this year, including inter-continental ballistic missiles (ICBMs). More than 80 missiles have been tested since Kim Jong-un took power, many of which have been successful.

Is this the first time that North Korea has claimed to have tested an H-bomb?

No. It had claimed to have tested a hydrogen bomb in January 2016 as well. Experts assessed at the time that the claim was exaggerated, because the yield was very low. The scepticism about the North Korean claims stems also from reasons of its economic backwardness and diplomatic isolation.

So, why is Sunday's test so worrisome?



Kim Jong-un on TV at Seoul railway station Sunday, after Pyongyang said it had set off a hydrogen bomb. The signs read "North Korea, important announcement". AP

appeared capable of reaching the mainland United States. The Hwasong-14 missile, the second to be launched that month, followed a steep trajectory that took it roughly 3,700 km into space. If this trajectory were to be flattened, the missile could cover a distance of 9,000-10,000 km, and theoretically hit the US.

On Sunday, Pyongyang followed up its claim of having tested a hydrogen bomb with the

met with a massive military response", and the President tweeted that the "United States is considering, in addition to other options, stopping all trade with any country doing business with North Korea". That list would be, of course, be topped by China — and the fallout of suspending all commerce with Beijing would be crippling economic disruption in the US.

SIMPLY PUT

head to survive the intense heat as the missile re-enters the Earth's atmosphere from space. There are also question marks about the reliability of a guidance and stability control system that can direct the Hwasong-14 missile accurately and intact up to the target. Finally, the missile will have to get past US missile defences before it hits its intended target. However, there is still the fear that considering the pace of its progress and testing, North Korea can have all these capabilities within a year. And the fact remains that not only has the US never tested its antiballistic missiles to shoot down an incoming missile in a real war, even in choreographed tests, these missiles have often missed their mock targets.

Hadn't Pakistan supplied nuclear bomb technology to North Korea? Was it involved this time too?

Unlike in the past, there have been no reports of nuclear proliferation from Pakistan or any other country for the current tests. But the basis for North Korea's uranium nuclear weapons programme was laid in the 1990s by the substantial help it got from Dr A Q Khan, the Pakistani scientist associated with Pakistan's nuclear weapons programme.

Khan led the clandestine transfer of uranium centrifuges, enrichment machines and technical data to North Korea over many years, according to Mark Fitzpatrick's book, *Nuclear Black Markets: Pakistan, A Q Khan and the Rise of Proliferation Networks*. Some of Khan's deals were tied to existing official agreements between the two countries, under which North Korea provided ballistic



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IMPORTANT QUESTIONS?

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

China is in a position to silence North Korea and China is not doing so for its strategic reasons. Direct talks appears to be the best option to de-escalate the conflict. Explain your view point?



ABOUT NORTH KOREA

LIVE

- Name is Democratic People's Republic of Korea
- Capital Pyongyang
- Language ... Korean
- Currency ... Won
- Population ... 25 million
- It is in East Asia
- It has got land boundary with 3 countries i.e., China, Russia & South Korea
- Armistice of 1953 ended armed conflict in Korean peninsula

HEADS / SUPREME LEADERS



KIM II-SUNG
(1948-1994)



KIM JONG-IL
(1994-2011)



KIM JONG-UN
(since 2011)

**NORTH KOREA ... HYDROGEN BOMB****NEWS REPORT**

- 1 North Korea claimed that it had tested a hydrogen nuclear bomb.
- 2 International experts felt that the explosion was at least four, and up to 16 times stronger than North Korea's previous experiments.
- 3 Some experts felt that it actually tested a boosted atomic bomb that uses tritium, a common enhancement technique for a higher explosive yield.
- 4 It is sixth overall and fourth under President Kim Jong-un.
- 5 North Korea has also launched as many as 14 missiles between February and August this year, which include Inter-Continental Ballistic Missiles (ICBMs) also.
- 6 More than 80 missiles have been tested since Kim Jong-un took power.



WHAT ABOUT ICBMs?

- 1 On July 28, for the first time, it appeared that it was capable of reaching the mainland United States through ICBM.
- 2 It launched the Hwasong-14 missile, which followed a steep trajectory that took it roughly 3,700 km into space.
- 3 If this trajectory were to be flattened, the missile could cover a distance of 9,000-10,000 km, and theoretically within the range of the US.

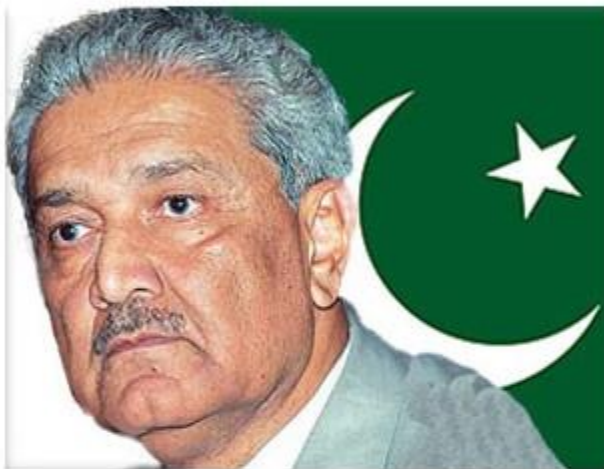


WHAT DOES THESE TWO EXPERIMENTS INDICATE?



1 Now, North Korea claims that this bomb can be fitted on the Hwasong-14 missile.

2 So, theoretically the US can be attacked with the missile along with a hydrogen bomb.

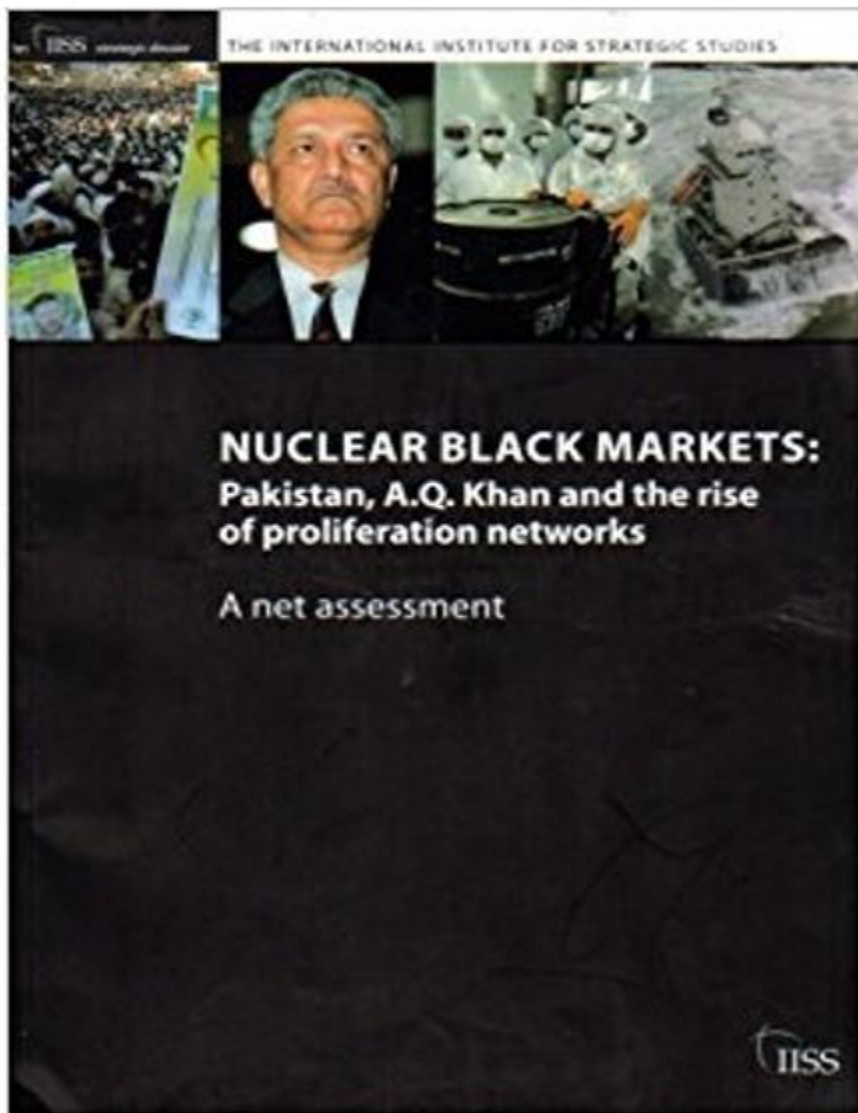


Dr. A Q Khan



NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGY TO NORTH KOREA ... SUSPICION ON PAKISTAN

- 1 We have to go back to North Korea's uranium nuclear weapons programme of 1990s.
- 2 It was developed with the substantial help from Dr. A Q Khan, the Pakistani scientist associated with Pakistan's nuclear weapons programme.
- 3 Subsequently, there were official agreements between the two countries, under which North Korea provided ballistic missile technologies to Pakistan in exchange for the help of the nuclear programme.
- 4 It was also reported that Benazir Bhutto was personally involved in finalising this exchange deal with Pyongyang during her official visit to North Korea in December 1993.



HOW FAR THIS SUSPICION IS CORRECT?

- 1 Khan led the clandestine transfer of uranium centrifuges, enrichment machines and technical data to North Korea over many years.
- 2 It was clearly stated by Mark Fitzpatrick in the book.



Mark Fitzpatrick

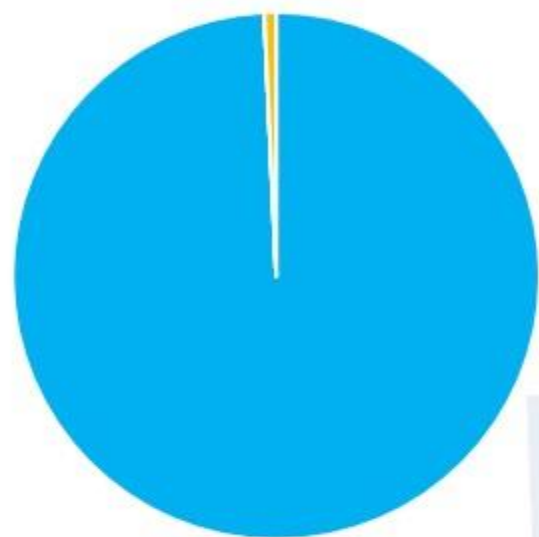


Dr. A Q Khan

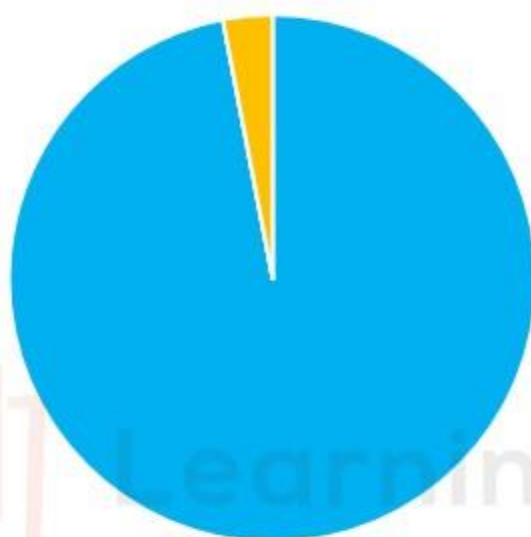


ENRICHED URANIUM

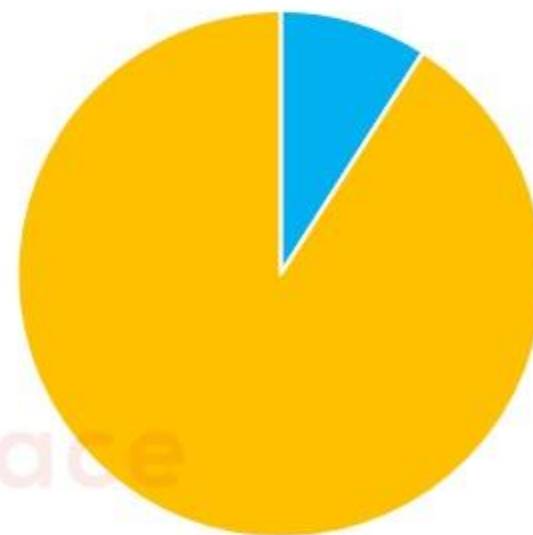
What do you understand?



Natural uranium
>99.2% U-238
0.72% U-235



Low-enriched uranium
(reactor grade)
3-5% U-235



Highly enriched uranium
(weapons grade)
90% U-235



WHAT IS THE US RESPONSE?



- 1 The US threatened to cut the trade ties with any country that conducts any form of business with North Korea.
- 2 Probably, this is keeping in view the major trade partner, China in mind.



WHY NORTH KOREA IS INCREASING THE MISSILES/NUCLEAR TESTS?

- 1 North Korea relies on increasing militarisation and show of missile and nuclear prowess for various reasons.
- 2 The reasons are:
 - i. It is a ploy to convince its impoverished and isolated citizens of the need for the country to attain military parity in view of the presence of the U.S. military shields in South Korea and Japan.
 - ii. To justify the years of the Kim family rule, so as to give an impression that the 33-year-old, third-generation dictator is strong.
 - iii. Issues like Iraq and Libya are in the mind of Kim Jong-un and he does not want a possible military conflict or to stave off any external intervention.



NORTH KOREA ISSUE ... WHY CHINA IS SILENT?

- 1** China cannot permit a regime collapse, because of strategic reasons.
- 2** As South Korea is a close ally of USA, if North Korea collapses, then North Korea may be subsumed into unified Korea, which will not be palatable for China.
- 3** Quite often, China says that the U.S. and South Korea should suspend their military exercises.
- 4** China is worried about the possibility of an unpredictable Trump initiating unilateral action, which could create an escalatory spiral.
- 5** China is also not happy with the U.S. decision to accelerate deployment of the THAAD (Terminal High Altitude Area Defence) missile defence system.



WHAT IS THE WAY OUT?

It is important to de-escalate the conflict by having direct talks involving the U.S., China, South Korea and North Korea. It is the best option at present.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

D. Sunil Kumar
V. Dayakar James
Y. Sri Poojita

G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

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